

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 6 3

♥ Q 9

♦ K 4

♣ J 9 8 7

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A Q 7 2

♣ 6 2



♠ J 4

♥ K 10 5 4

♦ J 10 9 5 3

♣ 10 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 7 6 2

♦ 8 6

♣ A K Q 4 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

rest of your winners, including 4 tricks in ♣s!

South's ♣ bid was Stayman, but he didn't match ♠s.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦J, West plays

♦K.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 8

With the ♦K onside you have 8 tricks, and only need one more. If ♣s split 3-3 you can get 2 extras and make an overtrick. But when you are missing 6 cards they are more likely to be 4-2 than 3-3. Since you only need 4 ♣ tricks you should establish the suit with a duck.

Win the ♦A and play a small ♣ from each hand.

The defense gets a cheap trick in ♣s but you don't mind because you still have a small ♣ for an entry to dummy. You win whatever they return and take the

If you had played the ♣s from the top you would have come up one trick short.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 4
 ♥ K Q 9 5 4
 ♦ J 7 3
 ♣ Q 10 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 10

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 8 7 6 4 3

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W		E
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♠ Q 10 9 6 3

♥ 7 6 2

♦ K Q 10 5

♣ J

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 9 6 4

♣ 9 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥5, East plays the ♥2.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You are very lucky. Apparently West led from ♥ K Q so you won an undeserved ♥ trick. Now, if ♣s split 2-2 you can make 12 tricks! But hold it a minute. If you play dummy's two top ♣s and they **DON'T** split 2-2 you will only win two ♣ tricks and the contract will fail. Instead you should play a small ♣ from dummy right now. The defenders will win the trick easily, but you will win their return and you will still have a ♣ to get to dummy's 6 ♣ winners!

Ducking a ♣ is the only way to make the contract and you might as well do it at the second trick.